

BOMI COMMUNITY COLLEGE

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TOPIC: The Digestive System

Course: Anatomy and Physiology 2

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Introduction

The digestive system is the body system responsible for breaking down food into nutrients that the body can use for energy, growth, and repair. It also helps remove waste materials from the body. The digestive system consists of several organs that work together to digest food, absorb nutrients, and eliminate waste.

Digestive System

The digestive system starts at the mouth and ends at the anus. Its main job is to digest food, absorb nutrients, and remove waste from the body.

Main Functions of the Digestive System

Breaks down food into smaller substances.

Absorbs nutrients needed by the body.

Provides energy for body activities.

Removes waste products from the body.

Main Parts of the Digestive System

Mouth

Food enters the body through the mouth. Teeth chew the food while saliva helps begin digestion.

Esophagus

The esophagus is a tube that carries food from the mouth to the stomach.

Stomach

The stomach mixes food with digestive juices and breaks it down into a semi-liquid form.

Small Intestine

Most digestion and absorption of nutrients take place in the small intestine.

Large Intestine

The large intestine absorbs water from undigested food and forms feces.

Rectum and Anus

The rectum stores feces, and the anus allows waste to leave the body.

Accessory Organs

Liver – Produces bile to help digest fats.

Gallbladder – Stores bile.

Pancreas – Produces digestive enzymes.

Common Digestive Disorders

Diarrhea – Frequent loose stools.

Constipation – Difficulty passing stool.

Peptic Ulcer – A sore in the stomach lining.

Hepatitis – Inflammation of the liver.

Nursing Considerations

Nurses should:

Observe eating habits and appetite.

Monitor bowel movements.

Assess abdominal pain or discomfort.

Encourage proper nutrition and hydration.

Educate patients on healthy eating habits.

Conclusion

The digestive system plays an important role in maintaining health by breaking down food, absorbing nutrients, and removing waste from the body. It includes organs such as the mouth, esophagus, stomach, intestines, liver, gallbladder, and pancreas. Understanding the digestive system helps nurses assess patients properly and provide effective care for digestive disorders.

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